

Sonny's Cozy Quokka Bedtime Tales

Book 32



Sunny and the Barking Gecko

WRITTEN BY JAMIE WIGG





The desert night was wide and full of stars.
Sunny wandered soft on cooling sand.



From underneath a ledge she heard a sound —
a tiny bark, where surely no dog was!



A gecko! Plump and patterned like the sunset,
with great big eyes for seeing in the dark.



"Was that your bark?" asked Sunny with a smile.
"It was!" he squeaked. "It's how I say goodnight!"



"I bark to tell the desert I am here,
and then I listen for my friends' replies."



And sure enough, from ledges all around,
came tiny barks like echoes in the dark.



"You see? We geckos never sleep alone.
The whole night desert wishes us sweet dreams."





His big eyes blinked, one at a time, then both,
the sleepest of winks beneath the ledge.



One last small bark drifted across the sand,
and one by one his friends barked back goodnight.



Sunny curled up by the sheltering rock,
still warm with all the sunshine of the day.



The desert hushed. The stars leaned in to listen.
Everything was peaceful, still, and safe.



Her eyes grew heavy in the starlit quiet.
One slow blink... then another... then no more.



And Sunny slept beside the barking gecko,
while tiny goodnights echoed through her dreams.



Goodnight, Sunny. Goodnight, barking gecko.
Goodnight, wide desert. Goodnight, little one.

The End

Sweet dreams, little one.

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